Securing
Your Digital
World

infoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

Congratulations, You're Still Insecure!

Why we fail despite billions invested

01.11.2025

/about me

- Stephan Berger
- Head of Investigations at InfoGuard
- @malmoeb on all platforms
- I blog, too (dfir.ch)

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

The Paradox of Cybersecurity

Kevin Beaumont · 2nd
Cyber weatherman
View my blog
8h ·

Connect

cybersecurity in 2025

Let me tell you a Story

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

The Silver Bullet that will make us safe

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- Every year brings a new wave of tools, frameworks, and promises:

Firewalls
Next-Gen Antivirus
SIEM
EDR
XDR
Zero Trust
AI-driven analytics

B	I	N	G	O
Encryption	Zero Trust	DDoS Attack	VPN	Blockchain
AI-Driven Security	Cloud Security	Phishing	IoT Security	Threat Intelligence
Big Data	MFA	Free!	End-to-End Encryption	Cyber Espionage
SOC	Cyberattack	Dark Web	Machine Learning	Next-Gen
Ransomware	Hacker	Cyber Resilience	APT	Endpoint Security

Master the Fundamentals

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- But behind the glossy vendor decks and soaring budgets, the headlines haven't changed.
  - **Company hacked!**
  - **Data stolen!**
  - **Ransomware cripples operations!**

- We've spent two decades and hundreds of billions of dollars chasing progress. And yet, by almost every meaningful measure, the attackers are still winning.
- Because the problem was never just technical.

  It's cultural.

  It's behavioural.

  And it's rooted in our refusal to master the fundamentals.

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

More Spending, More Breaches

More Spending, More Breaches

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- In 2025, global cybersecurity spending is projected to exceed $200 billion, the highest in history. Yet ransomware payouts are also at record highs, with some single incidents costing tens of millions of dollars.

- **Let that sink in: our industry has never been richer, yet our defenses have never felt weaker.**

- We've built an ecosystem optimized for buying solutions, not building discipline.

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

Groundhog Day

Two Decades of Repeated Mistakes

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- Every decade brings its own breach-of-the-year, a cautionary tale that plays out like the last one: a large organization compromised by a basic oversight.

  - Credentials reused.
  - Servers unpatched.
  - MFA missing.
  - **I'm speaking as a full time Incident Responder here**

- You could swap out the logos, the acronyms, the threat actor names, the script would stay the same.

Two Decades of Repeated Mistakes

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

> “It’s as if the entire industry is caught in a time loop, reliving the same mistakes and hoping that this time, the new technology will make a difference.

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

The Illusion of Progress

The Illusion of Progress

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- **Firewalls. Antivirus. EDR. XDR. Zero Trust.**

- Each evolution in security tooling has been presented as a revolution. Each generation promises to “finally stop the attackers.” And each time, we emerge a little smarter, a little more aware - and just as vulnerable.

- **Better tools. Same results.**

The Illusion of Progress

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- We've fallen into the illusion of progress. **We believe that because our tools are more advanced, our posture must be stronger.** Breaches aren't going down - they're increasing.

- We've built a culture of reactive acquisition, not proactive execution.

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

The Basics We Still Fail At

The Basics We Still Fail At

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- **Ask any incident responder what caused the last major breach they investigated. Chances are, it wasn't a zero-day exploit or a state-sponsored quantum attack. It was something embarrassingly simple.**

  - Patching
  - Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
  - Hardening
  - Password Management

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

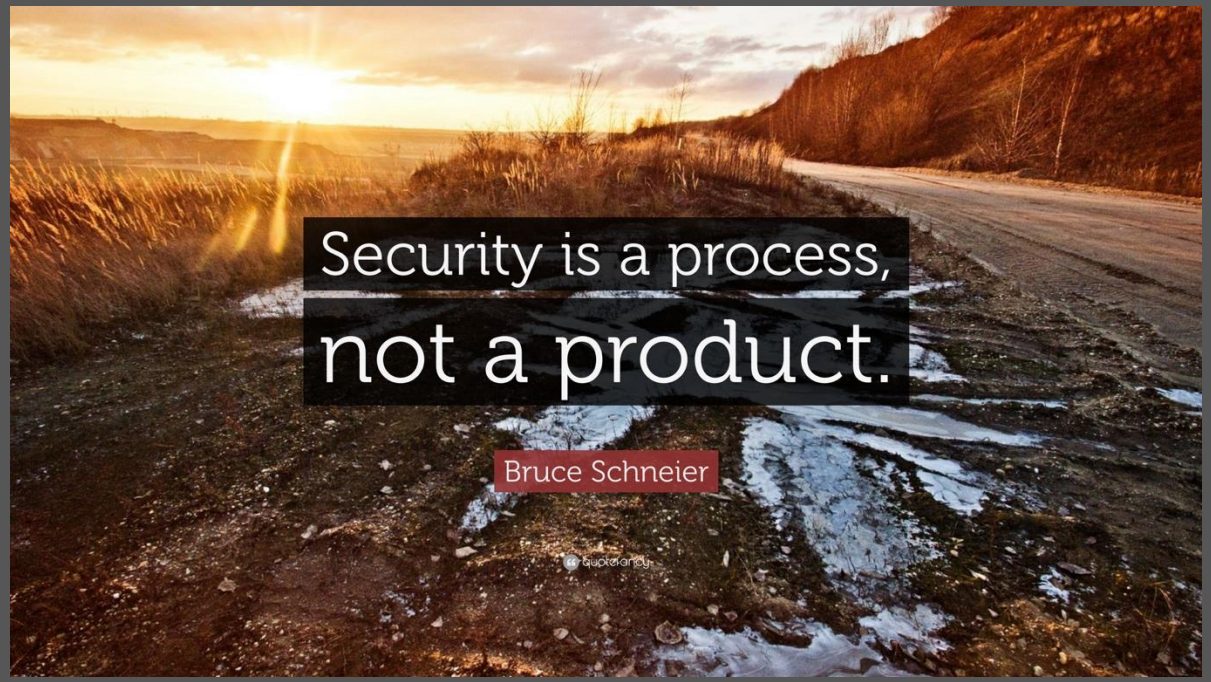
Why Tools Don’t Fix Culture

Why Tools Don’t Fix Culture

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- Security isn’t a product, and yet we treat it like one.

- **Organizations often approach security the way they approach technology upgrades: find the newest solution, install it, move on.** But that mindset ignores the human and procedural foundations that actually make security work.



Why Tools Don’t Fix Culture

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

“

Security is equated with compliance. Passing the audit becomes the goal, not building resilience.

Why Tools Don’t Fix Culture

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

“ CISOs lack the authority to enforce uncomfortable but necessary changes.

Why Tools Don’t Fix Culture

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

“ **Leadership prefers big, visible investments over slow, unglamorous improvements.**

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

Culture Eats Tools for Breakfast

Culture Eats Tools for Breakfast

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- Peter Drucker's classic line "Culture eats strategy for breakfast" applies perfectly to cybersecurity.

- **You can deploy every cutting-edge platform on the market, but if your people don't patch, don't follow process, or don't care, those tools become expensive decorations.**

- Culture defines behaviour when no one's watching. It determines whether

  engineers prioritize patching before release,
  whether employees question a suspicious email,
  whether executives demand verification instead of assuming coverage.

Culture Eats Tools for Breakfast

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

> **Without a culture of accountability and discipline, no amount of technology can save you.**

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

The Discipline We Need

The Discipline We Need

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- **Security isn't about brilliance; it's about consistency.** The organizations that handle threats best aren't necessarily the ones with the most tools they're the ones with the strongest habits.

- True discipline in cybersecurity means

  Patching fast, not "eventually." Automate it, track it, verify it.
  Enforcing MFA. Everywhere, for everyone, without exceptions.
  Hardening systems. Default deny, least privilege, constant review.
  Testing and training. Not once a year, but continuously.

- These are not novel ideas. **But excellence in execution, not innovation, is what separates the resilient from the reckless.**

The Discipline We Need

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

“

Discipline is hard. It’s repetitive. It doesn’t come with applause or flashy dashboards. But it works quietly, reliably, every single day.

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

A Call for Discipline Over $

A Call for Discipline Over Dollars

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- We've reached a turning point. The answer to our security failures is no longer "buy more." It's "do better."

- We must stop measuring progress by the size of our budget or the number of tools in our stack. Real progress is measured by behavioural change.

- **Artificial intelligence won't fix an unpatched server. Automation won't replace accountability. We need cultural change, not just technical capability.**

A Call for Discipline Over Dollars

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

“

Security hygiene beats fancy AI.

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

Call to Action

Call to Action

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

“We don’t need another revolution in tools.
We need a revolution in practice.

Securing
Your Digital
World

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

Closing Thoughts

Closing Thoughts

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- In the end, all the charts, frameworks, and investments boil down to a single truth:

> **“Security is not a product. It’s a discipline.**

Closing Thoughts

InfoGuard
SWISS CYBER SECURITY

- Until we believe that - and act on it - the cycle will continue:
  - more spending
  - more breaches
  - more disappointment.

- **But if we shift our focus from technology to culture, from tools to habits, from excuses to execution we might finally break the loop.**

What do you think?